



Atlantic Council

GLOBAL ENERGY Forum

WASHINGTON, DC • JUNE 9-10, 2026

WHERE GLOBAL LEADERS
SHAPE THE FUTURE OF
ENERGY

Falsehoods run wild in deadly Ebola crisis

Distrust and violence flare as rumors spread that outbreak is a hoax

BY RAELE OMBUOR, RACHEL CHASON AND LAUREN WEBER

NAIROBI — As a deadly outbreak of Ebola spreads through the eastern Democratic Republic of Congo, one conspiracy theory is that nonprofit workers brought the disease to get more money. Another is that the outbreak has been fabricated to frighten the population and gain access to minerals, including gold.

There are people who refuse to accept that preventing the spread of Ebola, which is transmitted through contact with the bodily fluids of an infected person, requires forgoing some traditional funeral rites. And there are others who do not believe Ebola exists at all — it is a fiction, they say, to steal aid money.

“There is mistrust of authorities and mistrust of humanitarian actors,” said Rose F. Tchwenko, the Congo country director for Mercy Corp, an aid organization, adding that some residents believe the disease is “fabricated.”

Last week, a group of young people unable to believe that their friend, a 30-year-old soccer player, had died of Ebola decided to take back his body by force, attacking a hospital in Rwampara

SEE EBOLA ON A11

Makeshift hospital: U.S. to send exposed Americans to Kenya. **A11**



President Donald Trump hosts a Cabinet meeting Wednesday at the White House, where he said he will not accept a “crummy agreement.”

Inside a university’s quest to purge ‘woke’ classes

BY LAURA MECKLER

GAINESVILLE, FLA. — Students in both classrooms were considering historic events. In Introduction to Sociology, the discussion was about globalization. Three buildings over, a Civil Discourse class was debating 1798 America and the federal government’s battle with the states for supremacy.

Both courses fall within the broad field of study known as the

Red-state schools are fostering a conservative vision for the humanities

humanities. But at the University of Florida, the class on early America is part of a growing and well-funded effort to counter what the state considers “woke” liberal indoctrination, while the

sociology class is considered a prime example of the problem.

One of these classes is being nurtured; the other strangled.

The Civil Discourse class is offered by the Hamilton School for Classical and Civic Education, which in just a few years has grown from an idea into a full-fledged school with nearly 50 professors, four majors, 69 classes this spring and tens of millions of dollars appropriated directly by the Florida legislature.

Not so for Introduction to Sociology. Beginning this fall, the class, which covers issues of class, inequality, race and gender, will no longer count as one of the general education courses required for graduation. Enrollment is expected to plummet.

The dichotomy stems from a conservative backlash to the liberalism that prevails on many campuses, something a growing number of schools have acknowledged.

SEE CIVIC CENTERS ON A6

For ESPN’s Mina Kimes, spelling bee is a ‘homecoming’

NFL analyst and winner of ‘Celebrity Jeopardy!’ will co-host the competition that shaped her youth

BY RICK MAESE

In a way, Mina Kimes’s next assignment isn’t all that surprising.

Before Kimes was one of ESPN’s most prominent NFL analysts, she was a studious kid who aced tests, devoured books and won trophies for spelling. If someone who knew her then had been asked whether she was more likely to grow up to analyze football on television or host the National Spelling Bee, Kimes said recently, “I think 9 out of 10 people would say the spelling bee.”

She won school spelling bees in the second, third and fifth grades and read so much that losing library privileges counted as punishment. “Obviously, I was very cool,” she joked. So as strange as it may sound that Kimes will play a prominent role on this year’s Scripps National Spelling Bee broadcast, she sees the assign-

ment differently.

“In some ways,” she said, “doing the spelling bee is actually more of a homecoming for me.”

Kimes will co-host the Bee this week with longtime spelling broadcaster Paul Loeffler, as 247 spellers gather at Constitution Hall for the 101-year-old competition’s return to D.C. proper. (The last 15 have been held in Maryland.) For Kimes, 40, the unique assignment is a chance to revisit the world of academic competition that shaped her long before football did — and get an up-close look at how it has changed.

“I thought I cared a lot at the time,” Kimes said, “but now as I read about these kids’ preparation and everything they do, I realize I had no chance of ever going far in spelling bee, even if I was at my school level, because, holy mackerel, the studying that they do is impressive.”

SEE KIMES ON A7



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

‘Feast of Sacrifice’ begins

Muslims in Jaffa, Israel, attend Eid al-Adha morning prayers Wednesday along the coast near the Mediterranean Sea. Muslims around the world celebrated the start of the holiday, or the “Feast of Sacrifice,” marking Ibrahim’s willingness to sacrifice his son in submission to God.

Acute dislike for both main U.S. parties, survey shows

BY SCOTT CLEMENT

The symptoms have piled up in poll after poll: Americans rate them unfavorably, say they’re “out of touch” and disapprove of their leaders. Record numbers avoid associating with them at all.

The diagnosis is clear: America’s political parties are afflicted with Chronic Unpopularity.

But what exactly do Americans dislike about the Democratic and Republican parties? To find out, a Washington Post-ABC News-Ipsos poll last month asked more than 1,200 Americans to describe in their own words what they dislike most about each political party. Open-ended survey questions are useful in tapping the top-of-mind opinions people have about a topic, which can be useful in understanding the ingredients baked into each party’s image.

SEE POLL ON A16

BUSINESS NEWS.....A12
COMICS.....B4
LOCAL LIVING.....INSERT

METRO.....B12
OBITUARIES.....B15
OPINION PAGES.....A13

POLITICS & THE NATION.....A3
SPORTS.....B7
STYLE.....B1

TELEVISION.....B6
WEATHER.....B16
WORLD.....A9

CONTENT © 2026
The Washington Post / Year 149, No. 54595

0 70628 21100 3

WASHINGTON DC
JUNE 9-10, 2026

LEARN
MORE

